

August 13, 2026

UnitedHealthcare
Provider Appeals
P.O. Box 30432
Salt Lake City, UT 84130

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Jenee Turcotte (MRN MUSC0686121), Claim MUSC-CC97-2

Patient	Jenee Turcotte (DOB 1979-12-30)
MRN	MUSC0686121
Member ID / Group	UHC683527916 / GRP-16096
Claim number	MUSC-CC97-2
Date of service	2026-03-05
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	E66.9 — Obesity, unspecified
Denied amount	\$594.59
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2027-04-05

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health Florence Medical Center submits this formal appeal on behalf of patient Jenee Turcotte (MRN: MUSC0686121, Member ID: UHC683527916, Group: GRP-16096) for Claim ID MUSC-CC97-2, covering services rendered on March 5, 2026 by Sarah E. Whitmore, MD. The claim was denied on April 5, 2026 under CARC 16 / RARC N290, with the payer remark stating: "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid," specifically citing a missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and asserts that the rendering provider's National Provider Identifier (NPI) was valid and present on the original claim submission.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Turcotte is a 46-year-old established female patient with active diagnoses of obesity (E66.9, onset 2015) and hypertension (I10, onset 1998), for which she carries an ongoing prescription for Hydrochlorothiazide 25 MG. She presented on March 5, 2026 at MUSC Health Florence Medical Center (Place of Service 22, On Campus Outpatient Hospital) for an outpatient evaluation and management visit of moderate complexity, billed under CPT 99214. The visit was rendered by Sarah E. Whitmore, MD, whose NPI on file with MUSC Health is 1447382910. The claim was submitted on March 9, 2026, within four days of the date of service, with a billed amount of \$594.59.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is RARC N290 — missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. MUSC Health has verified that NPI 1447382910 for Dr. Sarah E. Whitmore was included in the original claim submission in the appropriate data field. This NPI is an active, Type 1 individual provider identifier consistent with CMS requirements for outpatient professional billing. The denial does not appear to reflect an actual absence of this data element, but rather a potential processing or system matching error on the part of UnitedHealthcare during adjudication.

CPT 99214 was appropriately reported for an established patient office visit of moderate complexity, consistent with the patient's active chronic conditions requiring ongoing management. The primary diagnosis of E66.9 (obesity, unspecified) accurately reflects the documented, active condition with onset in 2015, and the secondary diagnosis of J06.9 was submitted as coded in the patient's medical record. The claim was submitted timely, the member's coverage period runs through December 31, 2026, and no clinical or coverage-based denial reason has been cited by UnitedHealthcare. The denial is purely administrative in nature and does not reflect any question of medical necessity or benefit eligibility.

MUSC Health requests that UnitedHealthcare re-examine the original claim transaction to confirm that NPI 1447382910 was transmitted in the correct loop and segment per standard HIPAA 837P transaction requirements. If a technical transmission discrepancy is identified, we are prepared to resubmit a corrected claim immediately upon notification of the specific deficiency. However, based on our internal review, the NPI was present and valid as submitted.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that UnitedHealthcare reverse the denial of Claim ID MUSC-CC97-2 and reprocess the claim for payment at the contracted allowed amount of \$277.18. Should UnitedHealthcare identify a specific and correctable data element deficiency upon review of the original transaction, we request prompt written notification so that a corrected submission may be made without delay. This appeal is submitted in advance of the appeal deadline of April 5, 2027, via the required electronic reconsideration process through the Claims & Payments portal.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)

- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record